

THE UNTOLD STORY OF BALOCHISTAN

“A Forgotten Nation–Within a Nation”

INTRODUCTION:

Balochistan is the largest province of Pakistan, full of rich culture, history, and natural resources. Yet, it remains the most underdeveloped and neglected part of the country. Many people think Balochistan is dangerous, but the truth is different. It is the government's actions that have created instability in the region. This booklet aims to reveal the wrongs done to Balochistan and show the world that Balochistan is home to peaceful, diverse, and cooperative people. For many years, Balochistan has been a land of broken promises, hidden struggles, and unheard voices. Even though it is the largest and richest province of Pakistan in terms of natural resources, it has suffered from unfair treatment, control, and conflict. "The Truth, They Don't Want You to Know" is not just about history, it is about the present situation of a people who have been "A Forgotten Nation Within a Nation." This booklet will expose the unfair treatment of Balochistan, the lack of care from the government, and the fight of its people for their rights. It takes you through the history, politics, human rights issues, and culture of Balochistan, trying to bring out the truth that has been hidden for too long.



CHAPTER 01: THE FORCED ACCESSION OF BALOCHISTAN

Balochistan was an independent state when British rule in the Indian subcontinent ended in 1947. On August 11, 1947, the Khan of Kalat (Balochistan's ruler) declared independence, and Balochistan functioned as a separate entity. However, Pakistan wanted Balochistan to be part of its territory.

Despite resistance from Baloch leaders, Pakistan pressured the Khan of Kalat and, on March 27, 1948, Balochistan was annexed by Pakistan. Many Baloch people did not accept this forced accession, leading to resistance movements and conflicts that continue to this day.



CHAPTER 02:

MILITARY OPERATIONS AND HUMAN RIGHTS VIOLATIONS

Since 1948, Balochistan has witnessed several military operations due to resistance movements against Pakistan's control. The Baloch people have demanded greater autonomy, rights, and independence, leading to continuous conflicts between the Pakistan military and Baloch nationalist groups.

Key Military Operations:

1. **1948:** The first military operation took place after Balochistan's annexation when Prince Abdul Karim of Kalat led a rebellion.
2. **1958-59:** Another operation occurred when Nawab Nowroz Khan protested against central control.
3. **1973-77:** A major insurgency erupted after Prime Minister Zulfikar Ali Bhutto dismissed the Balochistan government. Thousands of Baloch fighters and civilians were killed.
4. **2004-Present:** Ongoing military operations intensified after the killing of Nawab Akbar Bugti (2006), a prominent Baloch leader. The disappearance of activists, extrajudicial killings, and military crackdowns have further fueled the conflict.

Human Rights Violations:

1. **Enforced Disappearances:** Thousands of Baloch activists, journalists, and students have allegedly been abducted.
2. **Extrajudicial Killings:** Many missing persons are later found dead with signs of torture.
3. **Censorship & Crackdowns:** The media is restricted from reporting on Balochistan's situation.
4. **Displacement:** Due to military operations, many Baloch families have been forced to leave their homes.

CHAPTER 03:

THE THEFT OF BALOCHISTAN'S RESOURCES

Balochistan is rich in natural resources, including gas, coal, gold, copper, and minerals. However, the local Baloch population has long complained about exploitation and lack of benefits from these resources.

Key Issues:

1. **Sui Gas Extraction (1952-Present):** Balochistan's gas fields supply energy to Pakistan, but most Baloch areas remain without gas and electricity.
2. **Reko Diq Gold & Copper Mines:** One of the world's largest gold and copper reserves, yet local communities see little benefit.
3. **Gwadar Port:** A major economic project, but local fishermen and residents are being displaced without fair compensation.
4. **Coal & Mineral Extraction:** Hazardous working conditions and low wages for local workers, while profits go to outside companies.



CHAPTER 04:

LACK OF DEVELOPMENT AND EDUCATION

Balochistan, despite its vast natural resources, remains one of the least developed regions in Pakistan. The province faces severe poverty, poor infrastructure, and an education crisis, affecting millions of people

Development Challenges:

Balochistan has limited access to modern infrastructure, with many areas lacking proper roads, clean drinking water, electricity, and healthcare facilities. The region's economic growth is slow, and industrial development is minimal. Despite projects like Gwadar Port, local communities have not seen significant benefits, leading to frustration and protests.

Educational Crisis:

Balochistan has the lowest literacy rate in Pakistan, with thousands of children out of school due to poverty, lack of schools, and security concerns. Many schools lack proper facilities, trained teachers, and basic learning materials. Girls' education is even more neglected, with social and economic barriers preventing many from attending school.



CHAPTER 05:

CULTURAL SUPPRESSION

Balochistan has a rich cultural heritage, but many Baloch people feel their language, traditions, and identity are being suppressed due to political and social policies.

Challenges to Baloch Culture:

1. **Language Marginalization:** Balochi is not officially recognized in Pakistan's education system, and its use in media is limited.
2. **Restrictions on Traditional Attire & Festivals:** Baloch cultural events and traditional attire face discouragement and restrictions in some areas.
3. **Censorship of Baloch Literature & Media:** Books, poetry, and music that express Baloch identity or grievances often face bans.
4. **Erosion of Historical Sites:** Important Baloch historical and cultural sites are neglected or damaged.
5. **Pressure on Cultural Expression:** Artists, poets, and writers face threats or suppression when addressing sensitive issues.

Many Baloch people struggle to preserve their cultural identity and demand greater recognition and protection of their heritage.



CHAPTER 06: THE PAKISTAN ARMY'S ATROCITIES

The Pakistan Army has been responsible for countless human rights violations in Balochistan, with reports of abductions, extrajudicial killings, enforced disappearances, and military crackdowns. The province has been heavily militarized, leading to widespread fear among the Baloch people

Cases of Human Rights Violations:

1. **Major Nadeem Abbas Bhatti Case:** Accused of involvement in abductions and extrajudicial killings, reflecting the impunity with which security forces operate.
2. **Enforced Disappearances:** Thousands of Baloch activists, students, and intellectuals have gone missing, allegedly at the hands of security forces.
3. **Mass Graves & Kill-and-Dump Policy:** Bodies of missing persons are often found in mass graves or dumped in remote areas.
4. **Crackdown on Protestors & Journalists:** Baloch voices demanding justice face arrests, censorship, and state violence.



Major Nadeem Abbas



ANI News

CHAPTER 07:

MAHRANG BALOCH AND HER CONTRIBUTIONS



Mahrang Baloch is a prominent Baloch activist and human rights defender, known for her tireless efforts in raising awareness about enforced disappearances and state repression in Balochistan.

Her Contributions:

- **Leading the Baloch Yakjehti Committee (BYC):** A movement advocating for the rights of missing persons and justice for victims of state violence.
- **Organizing Peaceful Protests:** She has led mass demonstrations across Pakistan, demanding accountability for human rights violations in Balochistan.
- **Speaking Against State Repression:** Mahrang has bravely confronted state authorities and raised awareness through national and international platforms.

Her activism has drawn both national and international attention, making her a significant voice for Balochistan's human rights movement.

CHAPTER 08:

THE EMERGENCE OF BALOCH LIBERATION MOVEMENTS

The history of Balochistan's resistance is not just one of peaceful protests and demands for justice, it has also been shaped by the rise of various armed organizations, such as the Baloch Liberation Army (BLA) and the Baloch Liberation Front (BLF). These groups emerged in response to the long-standing political and economic marginalization of the Baloch people and the government's violent repression of their rights.

Baloch Liberation Army (BLA):

The Balochistan Liberation Army (BLA), formed in 2000, is a separatist group seeking an independent Balochistan through armed resistance against the Pakistani government. The group claims Baloch rights and resources are exploited, justifying its struggle as a fight for freedom and justice. The BLA has been accused of attacks on military and government targets, leading Pakistan to designate it a terrorist organization, citing its role in regional instability. Despite this, the BLA enjoys support among many Baloch who see it as a defender of their cause.

Baloch Liberation Front (BLF):

The Baloch Liberation Front (BLF) is a separatist group seeking an independent Balochistan. Founded in the 1960s and revived in the 2000s, it opposes Pakistan's control over Balochistan's resources and alleged human rights abuses. Labeled a terrorist organization by Pakistan, the BLF has carried out attacks on security forces and infrastructure but still garners support from parts of the Baloch population. Alongside the BLF and Baloch Liberation Army (BLA), other groups like the Baloch Republican Army (BRA), United Baloch Army (UBA), and Balochistan Nationalist Party (BNP) also operate, varying in their methods—from armed resistance to political dialogue.

CONCLUSION

Despite facing oppression and hardships, the Baloch people are known for their hospitality, bravery, and kindness. They take pride in their rich cultural traditions and warmly welcome outsiders. However, state narratives often portray them as separatists or terrorists, which is far from reality. The Baloch people only seek justice, equality, and respect for their rights. Balochistan is not dangerous, the real danger is the injustice done to it. The people of Balochistan are fighting for their rights, not against Pakistan. The government must stop military operations, respect human rights, and invest in the development of Balochistan. The people of Pakistan must open their eyes and support their Baloch brothers and sisters instead of believing false narratives. Only then can Pakistan truly become a country where every province is treated equally and fairly



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